NATIONAL GOVTECH POLICY ROUNDTABLE 2026

Theme:

Digital First Governance:
Rethinking How Nigerian Governments Serve, Engage and Deliver.

30th March 2026
National Assembly Library and Resource Centre.

Programme of Events

Background and Introduction

Over the past decade, Nigeria has made significant strides in digitizing government operations, from digital identity systems and data management to payment infrastructure and e-service portals. While these initiatives have improved efficiency within individual agencies, progress has largely occurred in silos, limiting their collective impact. Fragmented implementation, weak interoperability, funding gaps, and limited institutional coordination have created systemic barriers to scaling digital solutions across the public sector,a situation that, in some cases, has allowed corruption to persist and eroded trust between government and the citizens it is meant to serve.

This Roundtable, convened by GovTech Africa, brings together stakeholders from the three arms of government across both national and subnational lines to adopt a whole-of-government approach to digital transformation. The dialogue provides a platform for agencies to discuss pressing challenges, share experiences, and identify priorities for advancing coordinated, interoperable, and citizen-centric digital services. By leveraging digital systems across all levels of government, Nigeria can eliminate corruption, strengthen accountability, and promote transparency, paving the way for a truly Digital-First Government.

Rationale - Why and Why Now

The National GovTech Policy Roundtable seeks to push for a whole-of-government approach to digital transformation that is essential to eliminate corruption, enhance transparency, and ensure accountability to citizens. By connecting systems, standardizing processes, and enabling visibility across all levels of government, digitalization exposes inefficiencies, prevents misuse of resources, and strengthens oversight. This approach empowers agencies to collaborate effectively, ensures that public services are citizen-centered, and builds trust between government and the people.

Objectives of the Roundtable

- **Governance Priority:** Position digital transformation as a core governance function, fully embedded in public sector operations to drive accountability and transparency.
- **Whole-of-Government Coordination:** Promote interoperability and coordinated service delivery across inter-government and inter-agency lines, enabling seamless collaboration and integrated processes.
- **Legislative & Institutional Alignment:** Ensure alignment between legislative intent, institutional mandates, and implementation capacity for effective and enforceable outcomes.
- **Citizen- and Business-Centric Services:** Advance accessible, inclusive, trusted, and responsive services that meet the needs of citizens and businesses alike.
- **Sustainable Digital Infrastructure:** Build a long-term digital backbone through innovation, investment, and strategic partnerships, supporting resilient and future-ready governance.

- **Curb Corruption:** Leverage digital systems to reduce inefficiencies, prevent misuse of resources, and expose corrupt practices.
- **Build Public Trust:** Strengthen citizen confidence by ensuring transparency, accountability, and visibility in all government operations.

Key Discussions

Session 1

Digital First Governance: Rethinking How Nigerian Governments Serve, Engage, and Deliver

This anchor session will take stock of Nigeria's government digitization journey across all arms, with a focus on both federal and sub-national governments. It brings together the executive, legislative, and judicial arms of government, as well as major stakeholders across public institutions, to assess progress in deploying digital systems for public service delivery, regulatory administration, legislative processes, and judicial functions. The session will candidly examine persistent fragmentation, inefficiencies, and structural gaps that limit scale and impact, guided by a forward-looking question: what must change for Nigeria to move from adopting digital tools to becoming a truly Digital-First Government?

The discussion will explore the governance architecture required for seamless service delivery and cross-government collaboration, including interoperable systems, coordinated standards, and alignment across federal, state, and local institutions. Panelists will examine how policy ambitions can be translated into operational reality, how institutions can embed technology into internal processes, and how digitalization can promote accountability, reduce corruption, and strengthen government-to-government and government-to-citizen trust.

The session will also address the human and institutional dimensions of transformation, including civil service capacity, leadership accountability, change management, and funding for digitization. Key considerations will include public trust, data governance, privacy, cybersecurity safeguards, and legal frameworks to ensure digital systems are secure, inclusive, and rights-respecting. By surfacing challenges and identifying priority reforms, the panel aims to outline practical pathways for institutionalizing Digital First Governance across Nigeria's public sector.

Discussion Highlights:

- **State of Government Digitization:** An honest assessment of digital systems deployment across all arms and tiers of government, identifying fragmentation, duplication, and gaps.

- **Governance Architecture & Interoperability:** Strategies to transition from isolated digital initiatives to coordinated, interoperable systems that enable seamless service delivery and cross-government data sharing.

- **Policy Intent vs Implementation Capacity:** Assessing whether existing institutional mandates, funding structures, procurement models, and workforce capabilities are sufficient to sustain a Digital-First Government.

- **The E-Governance Bill and Oversight:** Evaluating the National Digital Economy and E-Governance Bill, and how legislative oversight can standardize platforms, enforce compliance, and embed accountability mechanisms for citizen-centered digital governance.

- **Institutional Capacity & Change Management:** Strengthening leadership-level digitization, civil service skilling, and organizational readiness to embed technology into core government processes.

- **Data Governance, Security & Public Trust:** Ensuring transformation is supported by strong data protection, cybersecurity safeguards, and accountability frameworks, reinforcing citizen confidence and reducing corruption.

By the end of this session, participants will understand how a whole-of-government approach, supported by innovation, investment, and strategic partnerships, can deliver a Digital First Government. They will gain insights into how digital transformation can strengthen accountability, reduce corruption, and establish a foundation for sustainable, citizen-centered governance across Nigeria.

Session 2

Building the Digital Backbone of Government: Innovation, Investment, and Global Expertise for Sustainable Governance

This panel brings together leaders from the private sector, technology industry, and development community to explore a critical question: how can innovation, investment, and global expertise come together to build the digital backbone that a modern Nigerian government requires?

Digital First Governance cannot be delivered by policy alone. It demands a combination of robust infrastructure, long-term financing, technical capacity, and strategic partnerships that are designed for sustainability and scalability. This session will examine how these elements interact and what Nigeria must do to transition from isolated digital projects to a government-wide, integrated digital transformation. The discussion will highlight how private sector innovation, global best practices, and investment from local and international development partners can strengthen government systems to support efficiency, accountability, and transparency. Panelists will explore how strategic investment in technology infrastructure can enable interoperable systems across government, facilitate data sharing, and improve service delivery to citizens and businesses.

Key areas of focus will include building financial and operational sustainability, designing effective procurement and project management frameworks, and establishing accountability mechanisms that ensure investments translate into lasting institutional change. The session will also discuss the role of the private sector and development partners in supporting inclusive, citizen-centered digital services that foster trust,

curb corruption, and enhance public confidence in government operations.

Discussion Highlights:
Private Sector & Development Partner Engagement: Examine the current contributions, opportunities, and challenges for private sector actors and development partners in strengthening Nigeria's digital infrastructure.

Infrastructure, Financing, and Procurement Gaps: Identify structural, procurement, and financing challenges that prevent innovation and investment from translating into sustainable, government-wide digital systems.

Policy & Regulatory Enablers: Explore the legislative, regulatory, and policy frameworks needed to attract investment, ensure accountability, and sustain long-term digital initiatives

Global Expertise & Best Practices: Assess how Nigeria can leverage international knowledge, innovation, and technical support while adapting solutions to local governance realities.
Institutionalizing Transformation: Define strategies to embed technology in government processes, build civil service capacity, and create resilient systems that enhance transparency, efficiency, and public trust.

By the end of this session, participants will have a clear understanding of how innovation, investment, and partnerships can jointly deliver a Digital First Government, strengthen accountability, reduce corruption, and lay the foundation for sustainable, citizen-centered governance across Nigeria.

Expected Outcomes
The Roundtable is designed to move beyond dialogue toward actionable reforms that advance Digital First Governance across Nigeria. Key expected outcomes include:

- **A Clear Reform Roadmap for Digital First Governance:** A consolidated set of priority actions spanning institutional architecture, legislative enablement, infrastructure investment, and governance safeguards to institutionalize digital-first operations.

- **Policy–Legislation Alignment Commitments:** Strengthened consensus on advancing the E-Governance Bill as a structural instrument for digital compliance, interoperability, oversight, and continuity across administrations.

- **Coordinated Investment and Infrastructure Signals:** Clear guidance for private sector actors and development partners on infrastructure priorities, regulatory expectations, and partnership pathways to support sustainable national digital transformation.

- **Global Benchmarking and Standards Alignment:** Agreement on mechanisms to benchmark Nigeria's digital legislation and governance frameworks against international best practices in data protection, cybersecurity, digital identity, and open government.

- **Strengthened Oversight and Accountability Frameworks:** Practical recommendations for monitoring digital compliance across MDAs, enhancing transparency, curbing corruption, and embedding citizen-centered safeguards.

- **Multi-Stakeholder Collaboration Framework:** A structured engagement pathway connecting government, private sector, development partners, and civil society to ensure sustained coordination and shared responsibility in implementing Digital First Governance reforms.

Conclusion

The GovTech Roundtable provides an important opportunity to review how the Nigerian government serves, engages, and delivers Digital First Governance with citizens' interests at the center. By bringing together stakeholders from the executive, legislative, and judicial branches, alongside private sector and development partners, the dialogue encourages collaboration, coordinated action, and shared responsibility.

Through discussions on policy, infrastructure, governance, and institutional capacity, the Roundtable seeks to identify practical reforms that promote accountability, reduce corruption, enhance transparency, and support citizen-focused service delivery across government. It contributes to laying the groundwork for a more integrated, sustainable, and trusted digital government that can improve service delivery and foster public confidence.

PROGRAMME OF EVENTS

	PROGRAMME	ACTION BY	TIME
1	Arrival and Registration of Speakers, Delegates, Participants	Registration Desk	9:00 - 9:45
2	Arrival of His Excellency, the Deputy Speaker of the House of Representatives		9:45 - 9: 50
3	Arrival of His Excellency, the Speaker of the House of Representatives		9:50 - 9:55
	OPENING CEREMONY		
4	National Anthem	Govtech Africa Media	10.00 - 10:05
5	Recognition of Distinguished Guests	Compere	10:05 - 10:10
6	Welcome Address	Director for Africa, Govtech Africa	10:10 - 10:20
7	Co-Convener's Remarks	Executive Secretary, National Assembly Library Trust Fund	10:20 - 10:30
8	Development Partner Remarks	Ambassador, Embassy of Finland in Nigeria	10:30 - 10:35
9	Development Partner Remarks	Resident Representative, United Nations Development Programme (UNDP)	10:35 - 10:40
10	Development Partner Remarks	Head of the European Union (EU) Delegation in Nigeria	10:40 - 10:45
11	Development Partner Remarks	The Ambassador, Embassy of Rwanda in Nigeria	10:45 - 10:50
12	Regulator's Remarks	Director General, National Information Technology Development Agency (NITDA)	10:50 - 10:55

13	Keynote Address	Honourable Minister of Communications, Innovation and Digital Economy	10:55 - 11:10
14	Convener's Keynote Address	His Excellency, the Deputy Speaker, House of Representatives	11:10 - 11:25
15	Chief Host Remarks & Formal Declaration	His Excellency, the Speaker, House of Representatives	11:25 - 11:30
16	Unveiling of the Nigeria GovTech Outlook, 2026	Head of Government Affairs and Policy, Govtech Africa	11:30 - 11:40
17	Group Photographs Close of Opening Ceremony	All Speakers, VIPs	11:40 - 11:45
	PANEL DISCUSSIONS		
18	Session 1 (Public Sector) Digital First Governance: Rethinking How Nigerian Governments Serve, Engage and Deliver.	Moderator – Principal Consultant, Public Digital Discussants – 1. 1. Head of the Civil Service of the Federation, Office of the Head of the Civil Service of the Federation; 2. 2. Chief Registrar, Supreme Court of Nigeria; 3. 3. Chairman, House of Reps Committee on Digital and Communications Technology; 4. 4. Director General, Nigeria Governors Forum; 5. 5. Director General, Presidential Enabling Business Environment Council. 6. 6. National Commissioner/CEO, Nigeria Data Protection Commission (NDPC)	11:45- 13:00
19	Special Address	Director General, Bureau of of Public Sector Reforms	13:00 - 13:10
20	Session 2 (Combined Panel) "Building the Digital Backbone of Government: Innovation, Investment and Global Expertise for Sustainable Governance	Moderator – Co-Founder, Truva Intelligence Discussants – 1. 1. MD | CEO, Galaxy Backbone Ltd; 2. 2. National Coordinator, Open Government Partnership (OGP) 3. 3. Resident Representative, United Nations Development Program (UNDP); 4. 4. MD | CEO, Nigerian Communications Commission; 5. 5. MD | CEO, Nigeria Inter-Bank Settlement System Plc; 6. 6. MD | CEO, Remita Payment Services Limited	13:15 - 14:30
21	Presentation and Adoption of Joint Policy Communique and Action Plan	Communications Lead, Govtech Africa	14:30 - 14:40
22	Closing Appreciation & Vote of Thanks	Global Head of Partnerships, Govtech Africa	14:40 - 14:45
23	Complimentary Tour of the National Assembly Library Trustfund and Executive Networking Luncheon	Head of Corporate Services, National Assembly Library Trust Fund	14:45 - 15:00

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